

Make a useful lender introduction and follow through

71 minutes including practice · 28 screens

Edition 2026-09-16-day4-quadrants-v1

Your Day 4 teaching reference

Use these explanations and demonstrations after class. Follow the four sections to find the task you need. Complete interactive record practice in Rep. Fictional examples illustrate the steps.

Help buyers prepare for a lender conversation

Day 4 · 71 minutes including discussion and practice

Learn how to connect financing questions to useful lender help. Practice the introduction and the follow-through so the buyer knows who will contact them and what happens next.

What you will learn and practice

For each topic, share your thinking first. Then study the explanation and practice the approach.

- 01Recognize when lender help would be usefulUnderstand the buyer's question before recommending an introduction.
- 02Know what to explain and what the lender must confirmSeparate an initial discussion from a confirmed financing outcome.
- 03Offer an introduction and understand concernsHear the buyer's reason, explain useful help, and ask permission.
- 04Complete the handoff and follow throughMake sure the introduction reaches someone and the buyer knows the next step.

Recognize when lender help would be useful

Understand the buyer's question before recommending an introduction.

01

Start by explaining what you would do. The teaching and worked examples follow your discussion.

Connect the lender conversation to a specific need

A useful recommendation begins with what the buyer wants to understand.

Understand the reason

"What would you need to know before deciding whether buying fits your plans?" Listen for the question instead of assuming they want to buy now.

Explain the purpose

"A loan officer can help you understand the payment and what would need to happen next. Would that information help you plan?"

Respect their relationship

Ask about a lender they already work with. Offer an introduction when useful and accepted. A buyer can choose to keep their current lender.

What Zillow Home Loans offers your buyer

Connect Zillow Home Loans to the buyer's next decision.

A clearer search

BuyAbility can help buyers estimate a budget using current rates. It is a starting point for discussion.

A person on the file

A named loan officer gives the buyer someone to ask about financing and the agent someone to coordinate with.

A coordinated next step

ZHL offers agent collaboration tools and status updates, including connections through Follow Up Boss.

"Let's get clear on a comfortable payment and what still needs to happen before you offer."

Know what to explain and what the lender must confirm

Separate an initial discussion from a confirmed financing outcome.

02

Start by explaining what you would do. The teaching and worked examples follow your discussion.

Pre-qualification, pre-approval, and final approval

These are different stages. Ask what has actually been checked.

Pre-qualification

Zillow describes this as an estimate using self-reported information and a soft credit check. Ask what the buyer has actually completed.

Pre-approval

The lender reviews supporting information and identifies conditions. Ask the loan officer what has been verified and what remains before relying on the letter.

Final approval

The lender must resolve the remaining borrower and property requirements. A pre-approval letter does not guarantee funding. Confirm readiness and timing with the loan officer.

[Zillow Home Loans FAQ](#), reviewed September 16, 2026. Ask the lender to explain credit inquiries for this buyer before they proceed.

Questions for the loan officer

Know which questions need a loan officer's answer.

Before the buyer proceeds

"What will you review at this step? Will it involve a soft or hard inquiry, and what should the buyer expect afterward?"

Before relying on a letter

"What has been verified? What documents or conditions remain? Does this property change the review or payment?"

Before committing to timing

"What can you support on this file, and what do you need first?" Give the buyer the confirmed answer rather than a general estimate.

Offer an introduction and understand concerns

Hear the buyer's reason, explain useful help, and ask permission.

03

Start by explaining what you would do. The teaching and worked examples follow your discussion.

How to introduce your loan officer

Use the buyer's own words. Ask permission before making an introduction.

Reflect

Use the buyer's goal or concern.

Explain

Offer one relevant benefit.

Ask

Get permission for an introduction.

Confirm

Agree who does what, and when.

Explain the reason before asking for an introduction

Fictional buyer: Jordan wants to understand payment options before deciding on the next step.

"You said the monthly payment is what you need to understand. Would a conversation with a loan officer at Zillow Home Loans help you compare your options? You choose your lender. If you want the introduction, how would you prefer to connect?"

If Jordan agrees, confirm the contact method and availability. If Jordan declines, respect the answer and agree on any useful next step with their chosen lender.

Complete the handoff and follow through

Make sure the introduction reaches someone and the buyer knows the next step.

04

Start by explaining what you would do. The teaching and worked examples follow your discussion.

Make the introduction and confirm the call

Permission -> introduction -> confirmation -> follow-through.

Jordan, meet Casey, a loan officer with Zillow Home Loans.

With your permission, I'm connecting you to discuss financing options before your next offer.

Casey, Jordan is available at 3 p.m. Can you confirm whether that works and explain the next steps?

Before sending

Get permission and agree how to connect.

After sending

Confirm the loan officer received it and the buyer knows what to expect.

In your CRM

Record consent, owner, agreed next step, and follow-up time.

Follow up on incomplete introductions

Review where buyers are waiting and who needs to follow up.

Review the dashboard

Review the team's current dashboard, definitions, and reporting window.

Check incomplete introductions

Look for introductions that stalled, unanswered questions, or an unclear owner.

Confirm the follow-up

Confirm the next step with the buyer and loan officer; update the record accurately.

Illustrative rate exercise

6 issued pre-approvals

÷ 60 eligible buyers

$6 \div 60 \times 100 = 10\%$. Use the rate to find the records that need follow-up, then inspect what actually happened.

What to do after this training

Day 4 · Zillow Home Loans

Ask whether an introduction would help. If the buyer agrees, confirm the call and follow up.

Use this training after the session

Revisit the explanation, try the exercise, then compare your work.

Find the topic

Use the four sections to return to the action you need. Read the example and the reason for the next step.

Practice again

Answer the scenario before opening its explanation. For a conversation exercise, use the buyer card with a partner, get one specific correction, and retry.

Keep a reference

Download the agent reference for the teaching and examples. Keep practice notes separate from real customer records.

Practice notes

Use fictional details. Write before the example, practice aloud, and retry one specific part after feedback. During a live session, submit through your own login; this printable worksheet is a backup and does not submit for you. The form follows the presenter. Submit before the class moves on, or ask the presenter to return to the question.

Jordan wants to make an offer

Jordan wants to offer but has not sent documents to the bank. What next?

- Promise approval today.
- Clarify what the bank confirmed and offer help.
- List every product benefit.

Choose one, then explain your own response.

Write your introduction.

Write your permission question.

What is the next action if the buyer accepts?

What would you clarify about the buyer's financing?

A buyer says, "My bank gave me a letter, so I'm ready to offer tonight."

What would you do, and why? What information would change your answer?

How would you explain the credit check?

Choose the sentence you would use with a real buyer.

- “Zillow never needs a hard credit pull.”
- “Pre-qualification uses a soft check. Let’s ask the loan officer what happens after that.”
- “Once you have the letter, financing is guaranteed.”

Choose one, then explain your own response.

What would you ask when the buyer already has a lender?

The buyer says, “My bank has handled everything for years. Why would I need another conversation?”

What would you do, and why? What information would change your answer?

Responding to common concerns

Choose one buyer concern. Respond in a way that helps them decide.

Which concern are you responding to, and what would you say?

Practice your introduction

Use Jordan’s situation. Keep it under a minute.

What one correction will you retry?

What changed in your retry?

Observe the assigned learner and round:

- Reflects the buyer's actual concern
- Explains one relevant supported benefit
- Asks genuine permission and preserves buyer choice
- Names an appropriate next action and owner; confirms after consent

Observer / learner / round / one correction / retry:

What would you do after an unanswered introduction?

The buyer agreed to an introduction. You sent it, but neither the buyer nor loan officer has confirmed a call.

What would you do, and why? What information would change your answer?

Check financing before writing an offer

Return to Jordan. The buyer wants to write tonight.

Your two-sentence update

Practice with a buyer and an observer

Trios: agent, buyer, observer. Switch roles each round.

What specific correction will you retry?

What changed in your retry?

Observe the assigned learner and round:

- Reflects the buyer's actual concern
- Explains one relevant supported benefit
- Asks genuine permission and preserves buyer choice
- Names an appropriate next action and owner; confirms after consent

Observer / learner / round / one correction / retry:

What do you remember?

Write first. Compare second. Fill the gaps.

1 · What are the four conversation steps?

2 · What does a pre-approval not guarantee?

3 · What makes a handoff complete?

Explain the buyer's lender choice

Show that you can apply the lesson.

- "Yes, it's part of our program."
- "No, but they will definitely save you money."
- "You choose your lender. If a second conversation would help, may I introduce you to a loan officer at Zillow Home Loans?"

Choose one, then explain your own response.

Plan your next practice

Choose a time to practice again without the slides.

Review after your first attempt

Use these explanations to compare your reasoning and correct any gaps. Discussion examples are coaching guidance, not automatically graded answers.

Jordan wants to make an offer

Suggested choice: Clarify what the bank confirmed and offer help.

Clarify the buyer's actual need before offering a relevant option. Explain one supported benefit, preserve lender choice, and confirm the next action only after consent. An introduction is optional; approval and savings cannot be promised.

Jordan, you want to be ready to offer, and we still need to confirm the financing. I work with a loan officer at Zillow Home Loans who can help you understand your options and next steps. Would an introduction be useful? You're free to choose the lender that works best for you. [If accepted:] Is a call this afternoon a useful next step?

What would you clarify about the buyer's financing?

Ask what the lender has reviewed, what is still conditional, whether the property affects the review, and what timing the file can support. Let the loan officer confirm the process for this buyer. Avoid promising approval, credit impact or a closing date.

How would you explain the credit check?

Suggested choice: "Pre-qualification uses a soft check. Let's ask the loan officer what happens after that."

Correct. Explain the initial step, then let the loan officer confirm what this buyer's process requires.

What would you ask when the buyer already has a lender?

Acknowledge the existing relationship. Ask whether anything remains unclear. Offer a second conversation only if it would help. Identify Zillow Home Loans clearly, ask permission and respect a decline.

Responding to common concerns

Already has a lender: "What do you like about working with them, and is there anything you still want clarity on?" If useful, offer an optional second perspective without promising savings. Credit concern: "Is your concern about the first step, or about what happens later in the application?" Let the loan officer explain the process; do not promise every step is free of credit impact. Required lender: "You choose your lender. My role is to help you understand your options. An introduction is available if you want it." If they decline, respect it and discuss the next step with their chosen lender.

What would you do after an unanswered introduction?

Check that the loan officer received the introduction and confirm a workable contact time with both parties. Tell the buyer what to expect. Record permission, the next owner and the follow-up time. Sending a message alone does not confirm the handoff.

Check financing before writing an offer

"The loan officer is checking the details for this property and what is still needed. Let's confirm those items and a workable timeline before we rely on financing terms in the offer."

What do you remember?

Reflect -> Explain -> Ask -> Confirm. A pre-approval is conditional; it does not guarantee funding. A complete handoff includes permission, an identified loan officer, a confirmed next step and owner, and a follow-up time.

Explain the buyer's lender choice

Suggested choice: "You choose your lender. If a second conversation would help, may I introduce you to a loan officer at Zillow Home Loans?"

Yes. You respected the decision and offered a concrete, optional next step. Now confirm the contact method and time only if Jordan agrees.

Buyer practice cards

Jordan • offer tonight

I love the house, but I have not sent my bank any documents yet.

Clarify readiness and ask permission for a useful next step.

Morgan • already has a lender

My bank has handled everything for years. Why would I need another conversation?

Acknowledge the relationship. Explore whether a comparison would help.

Alex • credit concern

I want to understand the credit check before deciding.

Respect the concern. Let the loan officer explain the actual process.

What each signal means

Connection status is separate from participation. A submitted answer is separate from a completed action. A record check is separate from writing quality. Record who observed a speaking turn and who reviewed it; a peer observation or self-check is not coach sign-off. Practice readiness, quiz certification, and activation remain separate.

After the workshop

Live session: closing the session creates assignments for recall within 24 hours, a fresh case in three days, and coach review in seven days. The session creator owns follow-up across the selected teams unless a different authorized coach was selected. Confirm the displayed session timezone. Due and overdue work appears in Rep; the daily digest links to work due or awaiting review.

Self-paced study: arrange those same checks with a coach. If there has been no relevant client opportunity, use a new fictional case and mark real-work application as not yet observed.

Keep the first attempt and correction. A useful follow-up asks whether the agent can apply the skill in another case.

References

- Zillow Home Loans FAQ
- ZHL agent tools
- CFPB: comparing loan offers